

Growing Together — Module 07: Communication — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. What is the hardest part about listening? (Waiting your turn!).
2. How can you tell if someone is really listening to you? (Eye contact, nodding, asking questions).
3. What is "Noise" in communication? (Anything that blocks the message — TV, anger, distraction).
4. Can you communicate without words? How? (Facial expressions, gestures, hugs).
5. Why is it important to say what you mean instead of expecting people to guess?
6. What happens when two people talk at the same time? (Nobody hears anything!).
7. How do babies communicate before they can talk? (Crying, pointing, smiling, reaching).
8. What is the kindest thing someone said to you today?
9. Why is it hard to communicate when you are angry? (Inside noise — emotions are too loud!).
10. What is your favorite way to say "I love you" without using words?

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Play "Telephone": Sit in a line. Whisper a sentence to the first person. Pass it along. What did the last person hear? How did the message change?
2. Try the "Drawing Duet": Sit back-to-back with a partner. One person describes a simple picture. The other draws it without peeking. Compare the results!
3. Use the "Talking Stick" at dinner tonight. Only the person holding the stick can talk. Everyone else listens. Pass the stick after each person finishes. How does this change the conversation?
4. Spend five minutes communicating with a family member using ONLY gestures and facial expressions (no talking!). Can you understand each other?
5. Write a short "Love Note" to each family member. Hide the notes where they will find them. Communication can be a surprise!

6. Record yourself telling a joke or a story. Play it back. Does your voice sound different than you expected? What did you notice?
7. Practice "Active Listening" for one conversation today: Stop what you are doing, look at the speaker, and repeat back what they said in your own words. How did they react?
8. Make a list of "Signal Words" your family uses. ("I need space" means give me a minute. "Family huddle" means come together). Create a new family signal word!
9. Draw a comic strip about a miscommunication. Show what went wrong and how it could have been fixed. Share it with the family.
10. At bedtime, tell each family member one thing you appreciated about them today. Clear, kind communication is the strongest bridge between people.